



vision**2**learn

Part of  Knowledgepool

Learner Handbook

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Welcome

Dear Learner,

Welcome to your [Vision2Learn online course](#). This course is being delivered through a partnership agreement with Vision2learn, the college and awarding body.

We're sure you're raring to go but please take some time to read through this learner handbook as it's full of essential information to help you progress as successfully as possible.

We hope your [Vision2Learn](#) course will help you to:

- Update your skills and enhance your employability
- Train for work or return to work
- Improve your CV and progress your career
- Study on your own terms.

During your study time with Vision2learn, you will have access to our learner support team. The team are here to help you with any part of your course, along with your online tutor. More details of who to contact and how can be found in the '[Who to go to for help](#)' section on the next page.

[We hope you enjoy your learning experience!](#)

Making online learning a success

To ensure that your online learning experience is rewarding, you will begin by completing and submitting the course induction (if you haven't already). You will work through a short series of questions and your responses will enable your tutor to offer you some feedback and advice on how to get the most out of your course. Your tutor will also learn a little bit about you and your learning style.

To help with [your assessments](#), please take note of the following advice to help avoid unnecessary changes:

Read the question a couple of times before you answer it. Make sure that of all your answers are in your own words, as copying content direct from the learning materials or from the internet is considered plagiarism, which is unacceptable. Work that is copied directly from an external source will be sent back to you to be rewritten in your own words. You must demonstrate that you have understood the text and, where possible, reflected on your own experiences.

Please make sure that you are familiar with the key assessment terms, which are **identify**, **describe**, **explain** and **outline**. A definition of each term is provided later on in this handbook and more detail can be found in the [hints and tips booklet](#); knowing these will help you to answer the questions with the correct level of detail to meet the assessment criteria. If you are not sure about anything, v-mail your tutor.

[Vision2Learn](#) wish you the very best of luck and look forward to receiving your first assessment.

Who to go to for help?

Online tutor: Your tutor is there to support you through your studies and to successfully complete the end of unit assessments. They are available online via v-mail to provide you with guidance and robust feedback throughout your course (v-mail is an internal messaging system which allows you to communicate with your tutor quickly and easily).

The learner support team: This team is dedicated to helping you successfully complete your course. If you have any personal issues which are preventing you from submitting **your assessments** please give us a call to discuss this and update your **action plan** in agreement with your specific centre.

The learner support team is available:

Monday	9am – 8pm
Tuesday	9am – 8pm
Wednesday	9am – 8pm
Thursday	9am – 8pm
Friday	9am – 5pm

You can reach the learner support team on **0191 215 4100**

Course-specific support: There is specialist support available on each course. Advisors are available to help in cases where you are unable to resolve issues with your online tutor and would like to discuss course content with someone. In certain cases, there is also an in-house course leader who can advise further.

The technical team: These are the people to talk to if you need advice on any difficulties you may have submitting work or any other technical issues that are not covered in this handbook.

There are additional tools to help you through your learning journey with **Vision2Learn**:

Group forums: Please view the group forums on a regular basis, as your tutor will post helpful information on here to guide you through your qualification. You can also interact with other learners studying the same course.

Learning to learn: This is an integral part of your learning and can be accessed through your platform. It will provide helpful study tips, along with help on managing your own time (both study and personal), to ensure that you get the most of your time with **Vision2Learn**.

Setting an individual learning target or goal

As you will probably be working alone for much of the course, you should set yourself goals toward which you can work.

We suggest that, as a minimum, you set aside 8-10 hours of learning per week, with a definite end date for the qualification. Please send your tutor a copy of any goals you set, so that they can monitor your progress toward them.

Your main point of contact is your [online tutor](#). They will support you throughout your studies and provide you with feedback to help you complete your course. You must contact your tutor via v-mail. If you have queries that your tutor cannot answer, please contact the learner support team.

Turnaround times: Your tutor must respond to you within 48 hours of receiving your v-mail. If you find that your tutor is not giving you the support you require please contact us so we can help.

Assessment feedback: Your tutor has 5 working days to mark and return your assessment as either a pass or resubmission. Resubmissions must be carried out within 5 days of receiving feedback to ensure that you do not fall behind. If you are unsure of what you need to do to pass, contact your tutor via v-mail for more support.

Quality Assurance: Quality assurance takes place at various stages of your course. Our team of internal quality assurers may review your assessments once a number of units have been passed and when your course is complete. If the quality assurer finds that more work is needed from you, you will receive additional feedback from your on-line tutor.

The college and awarding body may also carry out additional quality assurance checks and it is therefore important that you keep logging on to check if you've received any additional actions. Your certificate can only be issued once all quality assurance checks are complete.

Colleges carry out an [external quality assurance \(EQA\)](#) visit where your work may be chosen to be sampled. Please ensure that you keep your work up to date and complete any actions promptly so the EQA process is as efficient as possible.

Tips for using the platform

How to login

Go to www.Vision2Learn.com. Click Login and enter your username and password. This information will be sent to you in an email when you have been assigned to your tutor.

Login

Login to vision2learn here:

Username: *

Password: *

Login

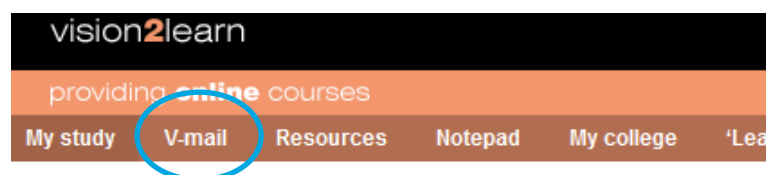
Reset

Can't login?

- Check your Web browser meets with our minimum [system requirements](#).
- Check you have entered your username and password correctly as passwords are

How to contact your tutor

Your tutor can be contacted via [V-mail](#). The v-mail option can be found on your toolbar at the top of the web page.



How to access your units

Once logged in, you will see your course units. Click on your course and then click on your chosen unit and session.

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My study

Hi a

Welcome to your vision2learn study area. This is the main page you will use to access your vision2learn course materials and to submit your completed course assessments to your tutor for marking. To access your course materials, simply click on the **course name** below. You can also use the icons under the **Task(s)** heading on this page to access the [action plan](#), [journal](#), [group forum](#), [portfolio](#) and [progress](#) page for your vision2learn course.

Your Courses

Course	Start date	Completion date	V-mail Tutor	Task(s)
Business and Administration Level 2 (2015)	21-Jan-2016	-	Lloyd Dishman	Action plan Journal Group forum Portfolio Progress

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My Course

BA level 2 2015

[V-mail tutor](#) [Action plan](#) [Journal](#) [Group forum](#) [Portfolio](#) [Course progress](#)

This Business and Administration course contains six mandatory units. To achieve your Level 2 Certificate in this subject, you need to complete all six units.

- Unit one: Principles of personal responsibilities and working in a business environment**
 - Session 1: Rights and responsibilities at work
 - Session 2: All about health, safety and security
 - Session 3: Communicating effectively with others
 - Session 4: Working with others
 - Session 5: Planning your own work
 - Session 6: Improving your performance
 - Session 7: Problems at work
 - Unit 1 Assessment
- Unit two: Principles of providing administrative services
- Unit three: Principles of managing information and producing documents
- Unit four: Principles of supporting change in a business environment
- Unit five: Principles of supporting business events
- Unit six: Principles of budgets in a business environment
- Feedback Form

How to access your assessments

The assessment for your course can be accessed from the course menu when you first log in. Simply click on the blue unit title to expand it. At the bottom of that submenu you will find the assessment link. Click it to access the page containing your assessment.

Your Assessments

Use the links below to submit assessments to your tutor.

Assessment
Business and Administration Level 2 (2015) - Unit 1 Assessment
Business and Administration Level 2 (2015) - Unit 2 Assessment
Business and Administration Level 2 (2015) - Unit 3 Assessment
Business and Administration Level 2 (2015) - Unit 4 Assessment

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Send assessment

Business and Administration Level 2 (2015) Unit 1 Assessment

To send your completed assessment to your tutor for marking, click on the **Browse** button below to attach the file and then click the **Send assessment** button.

If you need to send more than one attachment, click the **Add additional attachment** button. You can find out more about submitting your work in either the **Getting Started** section of your course materials or the first pages of the first unit of your course.

Please Note: Each attachment must be no larger than 3Mb.

Send Assessment	
Send To:	Dishman, Lloyd
Attachment:	Browse Add additional attachment
Subject:	Business and Administration Level 2 (2015) Unit 1 Assessment
Message:	

Send assessment **Cancel**

If the assessment link is not there, you will be directed to your assessment at the end of each session.

How to submit work

When you complete an assessment, you will need to send it to your tutor for marking. You can do this by following the steps below.

1. Log in to your [Vision2Learn](#) account and visit the [My study](#) area.
2. Each time you start a new assessment it will appear under [Your assessments](#). You will find the title of your completed assessment under the black "assessment" banner.

3. When you have found the name of the assessment you wish to submit, click it. A [Send assessment](#) page will open on the screen. Notice that the name of your tutor and the name of the assessment you are submitting have been added automatically.
4. To attach your assessment document, click the top [Browse](#) button. Use the file window to locate the file within your computer.
5. Left-click the file so it becomes highlighted and the name of the file appears in the 'file name' box. Click [Open](#) to add your file to your v-mail message.
6. If you have other documents or files to attach, select the [Add additional attachment](#) button and repeat the previous steps.
7. If you would like to add a message to your tutor you can type this in the [Message](#) box.
8. Finally, click on the [Send assessment](#) button. Your v-mail message and attachment(s) will be sent to your tutor.

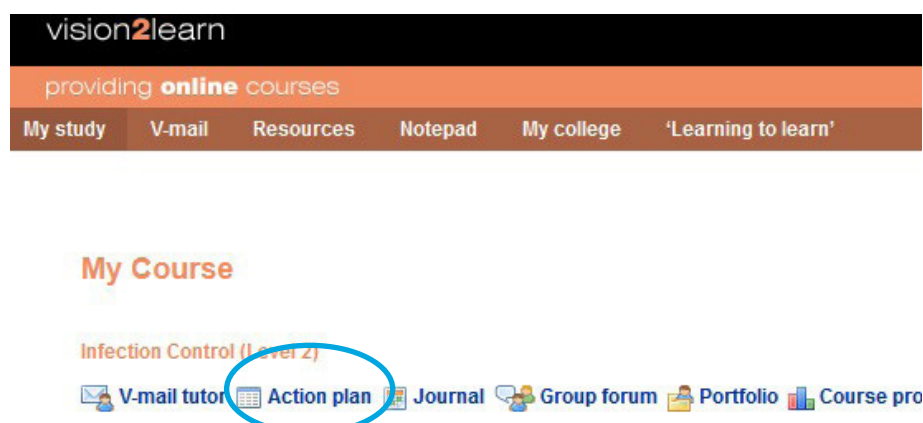
Once you have submitted an assessment it will be removed from [Your assessments](#) on the [My study](#) area. You can now track its progress on your [My progress](#) page. This page will allow you to see when your assessment is marked or needs resubmitting.

You can find a video demonstrating how to submit your assessment at the following link:

<https://www.Vision2Learn.com/video/submitting-assessments/multiscreen.html>

How to view your deadline dates

Deadline dates can be found in your [action plan](#). On your [My study](#) area, please click on the course you are studying and then click on [Action plan](#).



Study skills

This section of the handbook is designed to help you study successfully. It will help you to:

- Organise your study
- Make the most of your learning experience
- Define learning strategies
- Manage your time effectively
- Stay motivated!

10 successful study tips

1. **Planning your time** is the first step towards successfully achieving your qualification. In your life there will be many other things to balance alongside your studies, so it's important that you decide when you are able to study successfully. Try creating a weekly plan which includes all commitments, as well as time to concentrate on your studies. Please see the **weekly planner** further on in this handbook.
2. **Planning your study** will help to identify when you will study, how long you will study for and what you will study in each section. This clear plan will help to keep you focused on succeeding on your course.
3. **Organise your course materials** by working through each section thoroughly, making easy-to-read notes as you go. If you like to make handwritten notes or have access to a printer, you could colour code paper based notes about different topics and sessions as you work through, which can help when you're completing your assessment.
4. **Take regular study breaks**. It's important to remember that studying whilst tired can stop you from reaching your full potential. When working at a computer you must consider your posture and take regular breaks to refresh tired eyes.
5. **Make a note of your planned submission dates**. Although you can study whenever it suits you with **Vision2Learn**, it's important to keep track of your planned end date. By clicking on the  icon in your **My study** area you will find a quick link to your **Action plan** deadline dates. If you need any extra time due to holidays or other commitments you can v-mail your online tutor.

6. **Consider where you study.** Try to find a quiet area to allow you to study without distractions. Turning off radios, telephones and televisions will allow you to fully concentrate on your work.
7. **Make sense of what you are reading.** It is easy to lose concentration as you read through each session but being unfocused means, you will not fully understand the concepts and these will need to be revisited for the assessment. There are two ways of maintaining focus; the first is to complete the interactive activities throughout the sessions and the second is to record notes in your journal.
8. **Preparing your assessment.** Make sure to download your assessment and to read it through fully before you begin to answer questions. Once you have made sense of what you are being asked to do, please ensure you answer ALL questions, including relevant examples where required.
9. **Identify how you learn best.** As a learner, you receive and process information by seeing, listening, feeling and doing. Using real life examples will allow you to learn from experience through reflection and observation, so be aware of your surroundings and experiences to strengthen your answers. Do not rely completely on the course materials.
10. **Do not plagiarise!** The Oxford Dictionary (2012) defines plagiarism as taking the work or an idea of someone and passing it off as your own, including copying and pasting the course materials. Tutors will not accept work that is identified as plagiarised, so please ensure that all ideas are your own. Further information on this can be found in the [Academic misconduct](#) section.

Weekly study planner

In order to meet the guided learning hours – **10 hours a week** – please use the planner below to help you organise your study time. Remember to arrange your weekly activities to make time to study.

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thur	Fri	Sat	Sun
Pre 9 am							
9.00 – 10.00							
10.00 – 11.00							
11.00 – 12.00							
12.00 – 13.00							
13.00 – 14.00							
14.00 – 15.00							
15.00 – 16.00							
16.00 – 17.00							
17.00– 18.00							
18.00 – 19.00							
19.00 – 20.00							
20.00 – 21.00							
21.00 – 22.00							
22.00 – 23.00							
23.00 – 24.00							
After midnight							
Total study hours							

Useful assessment tips

Now you've started your [Vision2Learn](#) course, you will soon be completing your first assessment. We've compiled some handy tips to help you meet the assessment criteria and learning outcomes for your course and ensure [your assessments](#) are submitted smoothly.

Key words to help you

In the assessment questions there are some key words that you should look out for to help you compose your responses. These words can be interpreted like this:

List or identify – If the question asks you to list or identify, then you must write a list, like a shopping list usually with numbers or bullet points.

Describe – If you are asked to describe, then you must give a description by writing a detailed account like a story but not a list.

Explain – If you are asked to explain, then you must give your answer and also your reasons.

Outline – If the question asks you to give an outline, this means that you need to provide a few sentences along with some key points.

Avoid copying directly from course materials

It is important that you answer assessment questions in your own words in order to successfully pass your course. So, while you may need to refer to the course materials to help you answer a question, you should not copy passages or phrases word-for-word. This is known as plagiarism.

If you are suspected of plagiarism you may be asked to resubmit your assessment or, in serious circumstances, be removed from your course.

Referencing other material

Sometimes you may wish to use other material in your assessment, such as a news article or a quote. It is good practice to provide the name and source of the material and when it was accessed by you.

For example, if you used a news article to help you demonstrate an answer in your assessment, you could cut and paste the hyperlink to the article into your assessment, and type in the date that you accessed the article.

Important points to remember:

- Make sure it is additional to the course material.
- Make sure it supports/is relevant to your answer.
- Quote the source.

The main thing to remember when constructing each answer is to be as robust as you can. Try to include as much relevant detail from the learning materials as you can. It is very important to use your own words. The following information should be helpful to you. If you have any queries get in touch with your tutor using v-mail.

Guidelines for acceptable conduct

Academic misconduct

As previously highlighted in the [Assessment hints and tips](#) section, plagiarism will not be tolerated.

- Reading other people's ideas about a topic is perfectly legitimate research and forming your own ideas from that research is absolutely fine, but the other person's work must not be copied word for word.
- Quoting other people's work word for word is only acceptable [provided credit is given to the author of that work](#) (e.g. in a reference footnote spelling out the source). In this case you should explain in your own words why the quote is important or relevant to your own ideas.
- Course materials cannot be copied and pasted into your submissions; this is a form of plagiarism and will not be accepted.

Learners who are rude to members of staff including in-house staff and online tutors will not be tolerated. Please remember that we are all here to support you and to work together to help you complete your course successfully.

Appeals procedure

If you are unhappy with any aspect of the course, your tutor or the level of support that you receive, we first recommend v-mailing this with your tutor. Please v-mail your tutor with any concerns to make them aware of the situation.

The next step, if your tutor cannot resolve your issues, is to speak to the [Vision2Learn](#) learner support team. The Learner support team will be able to further advise you and forward your appeal to the correct person.

Personal extenuating circumstances

If you cannot submit your work for any reason please v-mail your tutor. Tutors can provide learners with extensions of up to 2 weeks. If any extra time is required please get in touch with our learner support team as they can then contact the centre to request further extensions.